



Digital SLR test



Nikon's new dSLR, the D5000 comes with a foldable screen



Taking close-up shots is difficult with the standard shooting modes. The flash unit isn't particularly good either. It's bright enough for close areas and is too focussed on a narrow area. The build quality of the hinge and the flash unit isn't very good.

Although this was a good entry-level Canon dSLR prior to the release of the EOS 1000D, in comparison, using it isn't a very simple task, given its user interface. The menus are basic and sketchy. Using it with the Auto shooting mode gives decent results though.

Getting good shots in low-light situations can be a little difficult. It often requires you to increase the aperture size by a significant amount and also set the ISO to its maximum — 1600 to use a 1/30 second shot. Fortunately, the amount of grain at higher ISO levels is low and manageable and image adjustments can fix this.

The camera uses CompactFlash memory. The EOS 500D has just been launched and so the EOS 400D will slowly be phased out. Availability might soon be a problem, but at the same time, it's also interesting to find low prices for the EOS 400D.

Canon EOS 1000D

Canon's new EOS 1000D competes with the Nikon D60. The 1000D lies at the bottom of the pyramid of cameras from Canon. The EOS 1000D is a smaller camera and also a light one. In looks, it appears a little more refined and polished than the other cameras. The corners are rounded and so are all the buttons. It almost feels like a P&S from the rear end of the camera around the screen. The finish isn't very nice. It feels very sandy and it's not the best feel you would wish for when you're holding a camera. It's also light and so attaching a big lens will probably upset the balance significantly. Very light dSLRs are probably not a good idea.

Large markings are present everywhere to inform the user of the controls. Clearly, this camera was made for a beginner who possibly might even buy a dSLR as his first camera. It's not as impressive as the D60 though.

One of the key features of the EOS 1000D is the Live View. It's similar to the one found in the Nikon D90. It lets you use the LCD screen to focus. This should prove convenient to P&S users not used to a viewfinder. There is a slight delay as expected and we're really not so impressed — many would agree that the old viewfinder way of focussing is the way to go.

The buttons on the EOS 1000D are flat and easy to push. The jog dial feels as if it has large notches and isn't as smooth and light as the other buttons and dials on the camera. Unlike the other Canons and the Sony, the EOS 1000D uses an SD/SDHC card. The body is built well and the flash hinge and structure is slightly better on this than the 400D. The lens itself looks similar and has a slightly silky grip which we didn't like. There's also the missing thumb-grip near the screen which was present in the EOS 400D.

The menus on the 1000D are basic but not as amazing as the 50D. The controls are a little more manual with the 1000D. Most of the controls are to be changed using the button and jogdial combination instead of using the direction keys in the software menu. The zoom buttons for the preview are set into bevelled slots on the back of the camera.

Focussing is simple and straight forward. Macro shots are fairly easy to take as well. The camera feels and works a lot like the EOS 400D and it also happens to replace and take its place in the price range.

The menu drags it all down, unfortunately. The A200 in comparison feels richer. The EOS 1000D is a slightly better camera than the aged 400D in image quality, but we preferred the body and ergonomics on the EOS 400D. The MRP for the Canon EOS 1000D is Rs. 34,995.

Canon EOS 50D

One of the most special cameras in this



Canon EOS 50D

test has to be the EOS 50D. It's sheer size and feel in hand was enough to get positive responses from everyone who used it. The EOS 50D was released late last year to replace the EOS 40D. Like its predecessor, the EOS 50D isn't a full-frame camera, but it has a good 15-MP CMOS sensor. The DIGIC 4 processor is one of the other revisions made to the camera.

This is larger than the others cameras that we tested. The EOS 50D also has slightly different controls from the others. The biggest difference lay with the large dial ring in place of the direction arrows. The directional arrows on the 50D are replaced by a joystick, rather like the ones found in mobile phones except this one is really sturdy and a little hard to use. Like the D90, the 50D uses two dials dedicated to change shutter speed and aperture in the manual mode. In the aperture or shutter priority mode, the jog dial at the front is used.

The camera is also wider than some of the other cameras. A lot of space on the rear isn't used and only the dial-wheel and the joystick are present. All other controls such as the ISO level, white balance settings, and the autofocus settings are present on top, right behind the tiny screen on top of the camera.

Using this camera isn't particularly easy. It's more geared towards the more advanced enthusiast. If you're used to dSLRs, then you can get around it in an hour or so. The interface is more refined than other cameras and Canon has also tried to ease things by adding little fade-in effects and some colour to the menus — in our opinion is a nice touch.

The screen is of very good quality and is positioned well on the left. It displays colour accurately and controls for the brightness for the screen are easily accessible — this is a good thing when you're working in extremely dark or bright places. The primary information display is well thought of and has all the settings you need. All the menus and features work really quickly.

Canon EOS 1000D

